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SABLE HARBOR ADVISORY — EXPERT NETWORK AND THIRD-PARTY STANDARD

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Owner: Advisory Operations with Legal, Security and Procurement

Related: SH-ADV-006–009; enterprise procurement/security controls

1. Purpose

Advisory may use external experts, specialist boutiques, technical subcontractors, data providers and other third parties to solve consequential problems. The firm remains accountable for what it promises the client and does not outsource professional responsibility merely because a specialist contributed.

2. Third-party categories

- **Expert adviser** — individual domain specialist providing bounded knowledge/judgment.
- **Specialist subcontractor** — firm performing defined professional/technical work.
- **Technical provider** — software, data, model, infrastructure or engineering service.
- **Field provider** — survey, laboratory, inspection, engineering, contractor or operating specialist.
- **Research/data provider** — licensed data, publications, intelligence feeds or research support.

3. Due diligence

Before material use, the matter confirms proportionate diligence on:

- identity and ownership;

- competence/credentials;
- conflicts;
- confidentiality;
- information security;
- sanctions/bribery/corruption risk where relevant;
- insurance/licensing where relevant;
- data/IP rights;
- subcontracting chain;
- safety/field qualifications;
- reputation/integrity;
- availability and continuity.

4. Client disclosure

Material subcontractors and critical technical providers are disclosed where contract, regulation, privacy/security terms or professional expectations require. Sable Harbor does not misrepresent outsourced work as entirely in-house where that distinction matters.

5. Access

Third parties receive the minimum useful matter access. Access is time-bounded, revocable and recorded. They do not receive general Atlas Professional access, cross-client memory, J2 material or operating-business secrets unrelated to their assignment.

6. Confidentiality and IP

Contracts require appropriate confidentiality, invention/IP treatment, data use limits, security and return/deletion obligations. Sable Harbor confirms that third-party licenses permit any intended client transfer.

7. Expert calls

Expert calls are not treated as unstructured sources of truth. The matter record captures:

- expert identity/qualification;
- conflict screen;
- topic;
- date;
- material factual statements or judgments relied upon;
- limitations;
- whether corroboration is required.

The firm does not solicit confidential information the expert is not entitled to disclose.

8. Models and AI providers

For material external model/tool use, Atlas records provider/model/version, data handling, retention/training terms where known, geographic/contract constraints, evaluation results and fallback behavior.

A third-party model update does not silently change a consequential transferred workflow.

9. Field and engineering specialists

When third-party work affects physical operations, the matter identifies professional licensure, site authority, safety responsibilities, deliverable ownership and quality review. Advisory does not imply engineering/survey/legal certification that Sable Harbor itself is not qualified or authorized to issue.

10. Performance management

Material providers are assessed on:

- quality;
- timeliness;
- integrity;
- security;
- client impact;
- rework;
- transferability of deliverables;
- commercial performance.

Repeated failures are visible institutionally.

11. Independence

External experts with financial interests in the client, competitor, transaction or recommended solution require explicit disclosure and conflict assessment. A supposedly independent expert should not be paid primarily for reaching a favorable conclusion.

12. Contingency and concentration

Advisory monitors critical dependence on single data/model/cloud/specialist providers. Q3/Q4 matters identify fallback arrangements where a provider failure could compromise the client outcome or matter record.

13. Professional standard

A client should be able to benefit from the best available specialist capability while still knowing that Sable Harbor owns the integration, professional judgment, quality control and transfer promise of the matter it accepted.